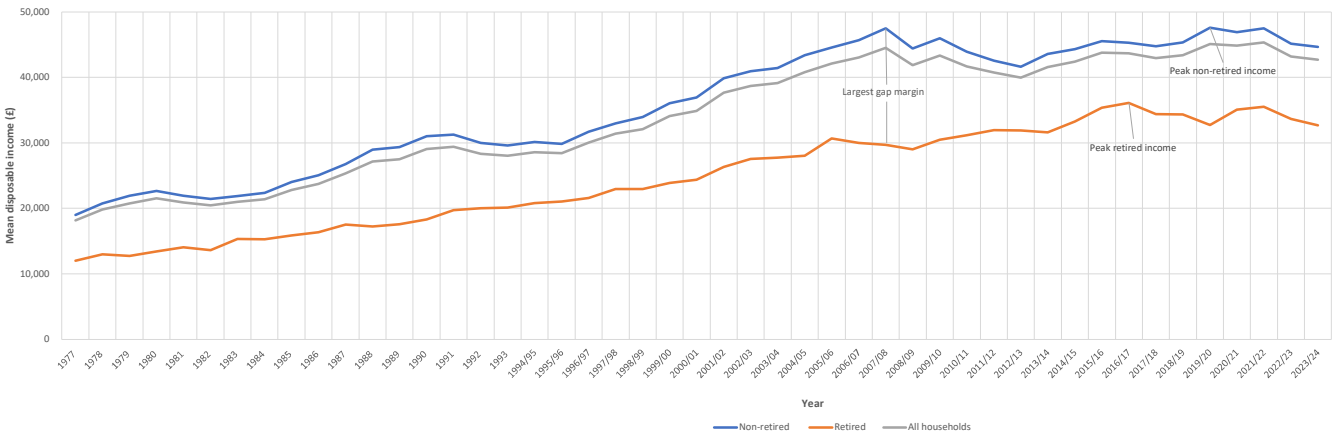
Dashboard of Timeseries Charts showing UK Household Disposable Income Data from 1977 to 2024 (adjusted for 2023/24 prices)

Summary Insights

1. Income inequality remains a consistent feature of the UK, with higher-income households maintaining a substantial advantage over lower-income groups throughout the period
2. Income growth has not been evenly distributed, with higher-income households generally experiencing stronger long-term gains compared to lower-income groups
3. The rate of change in income inequality fluctuates over time, with periods of both widening and narrowing gaps reflecting broader economic conditions

Timeseries of mean equivalised disposable UK household income for retired and non-retired households from 1977 to 2024



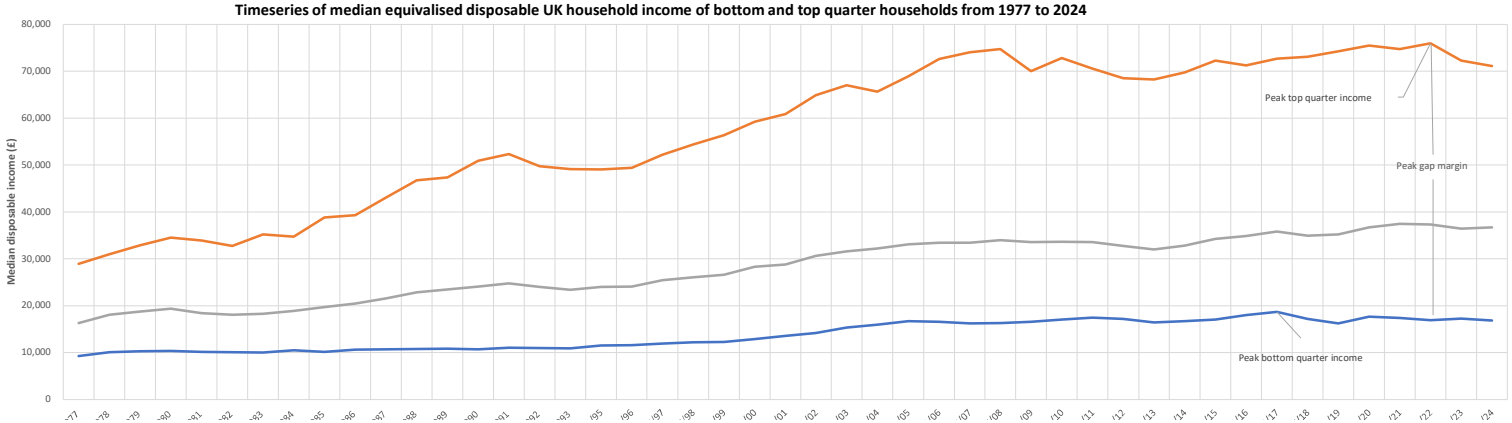
Insights

Working households consistently have higher disposable income than retired households over the entire period.

Both groups show long-term income growth, but the gap between them remains persistent.

Retired household income appears more stable, while working household income shows greater variation over time.

Timeseries of median equivalised disposable UK household income of bottom and top quarter households from 1977 to 2024

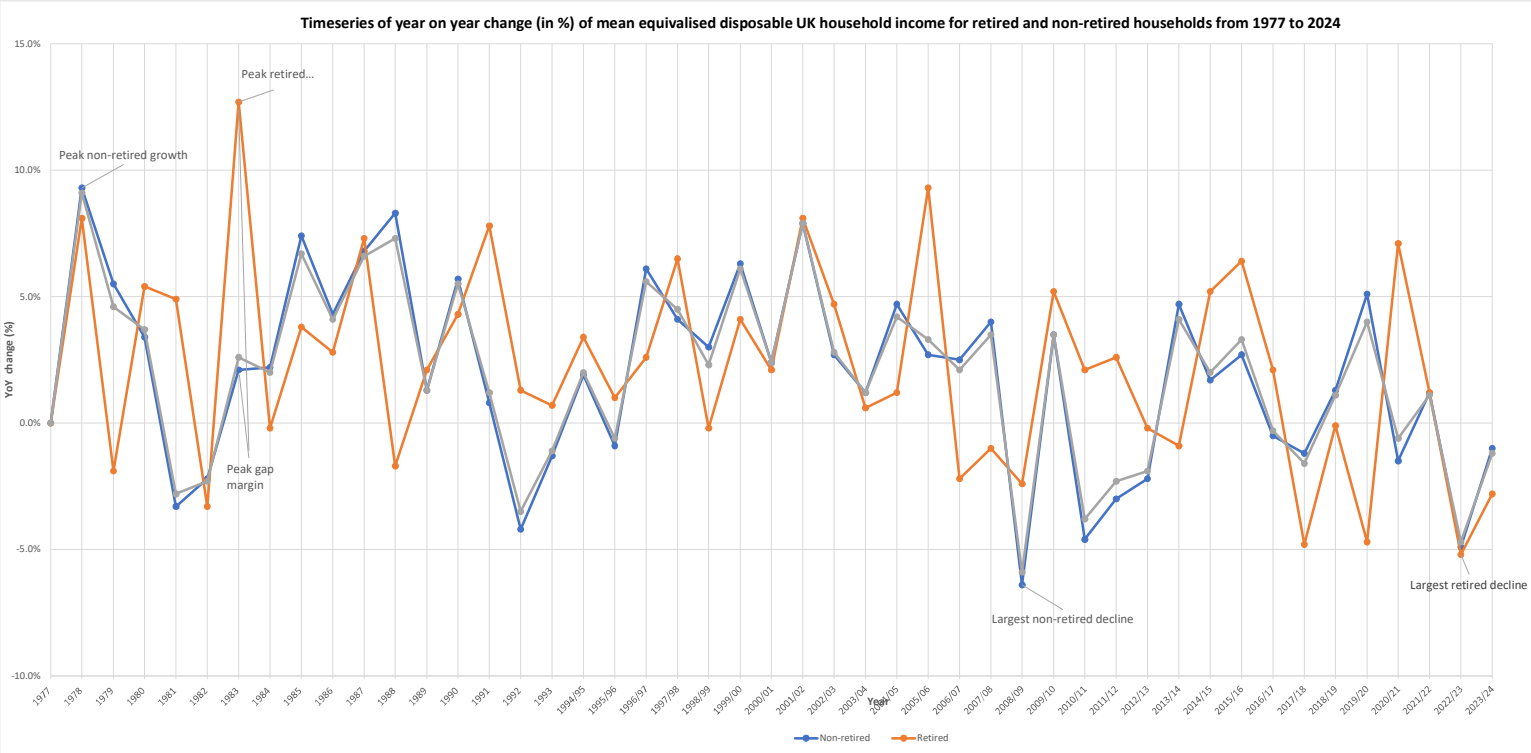


Insights

Households in the top quartile consistently have significantly higher income than those in the bottom quartile.

Both groups experience income growth over time, but the gap between them remains substantial.

Income growth appears stronger for higher-income households, particularly in later years.

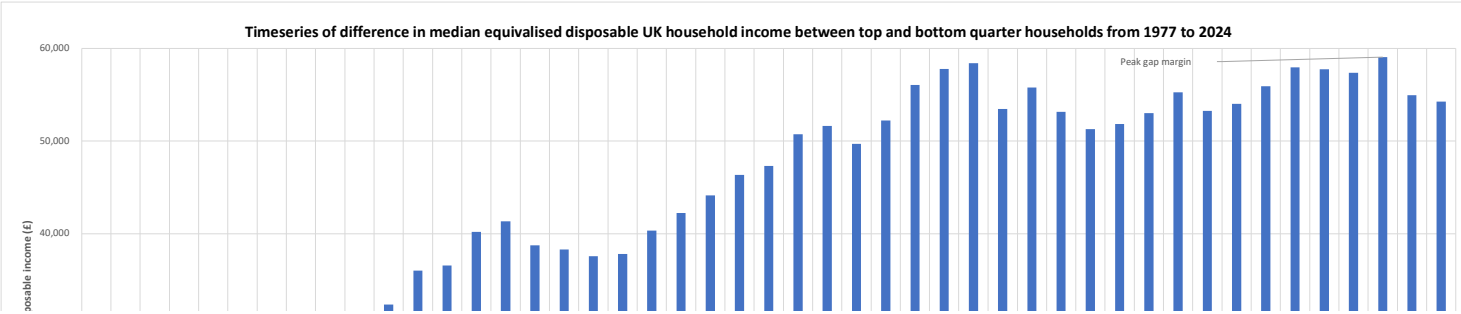


Insights

Income growth fluctuates significantly year to year, indicating periods of both expansion and stagnation.

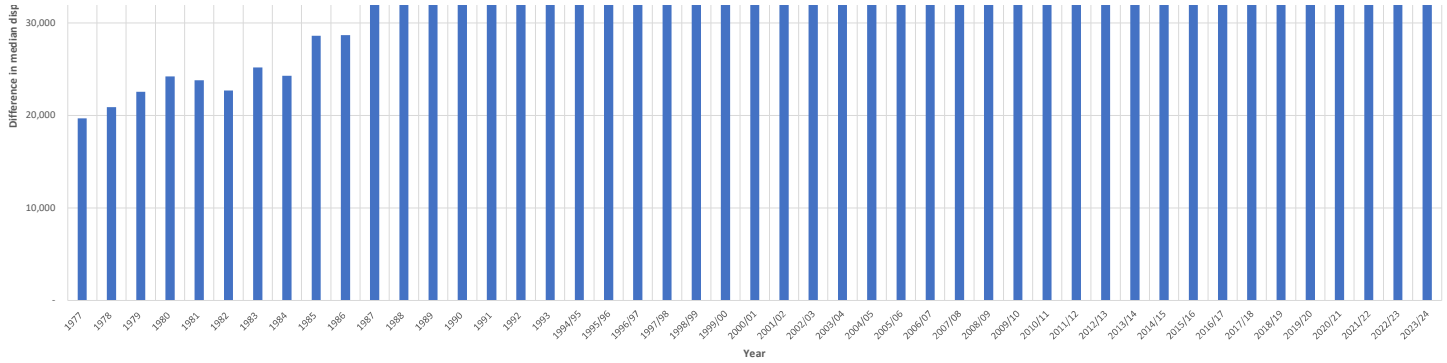
There are noticeable periods of negative growth, suggesting economic downturns affecting household income.

Growth patterns are broadly similar across groups, though some variation exists between working and retired households.



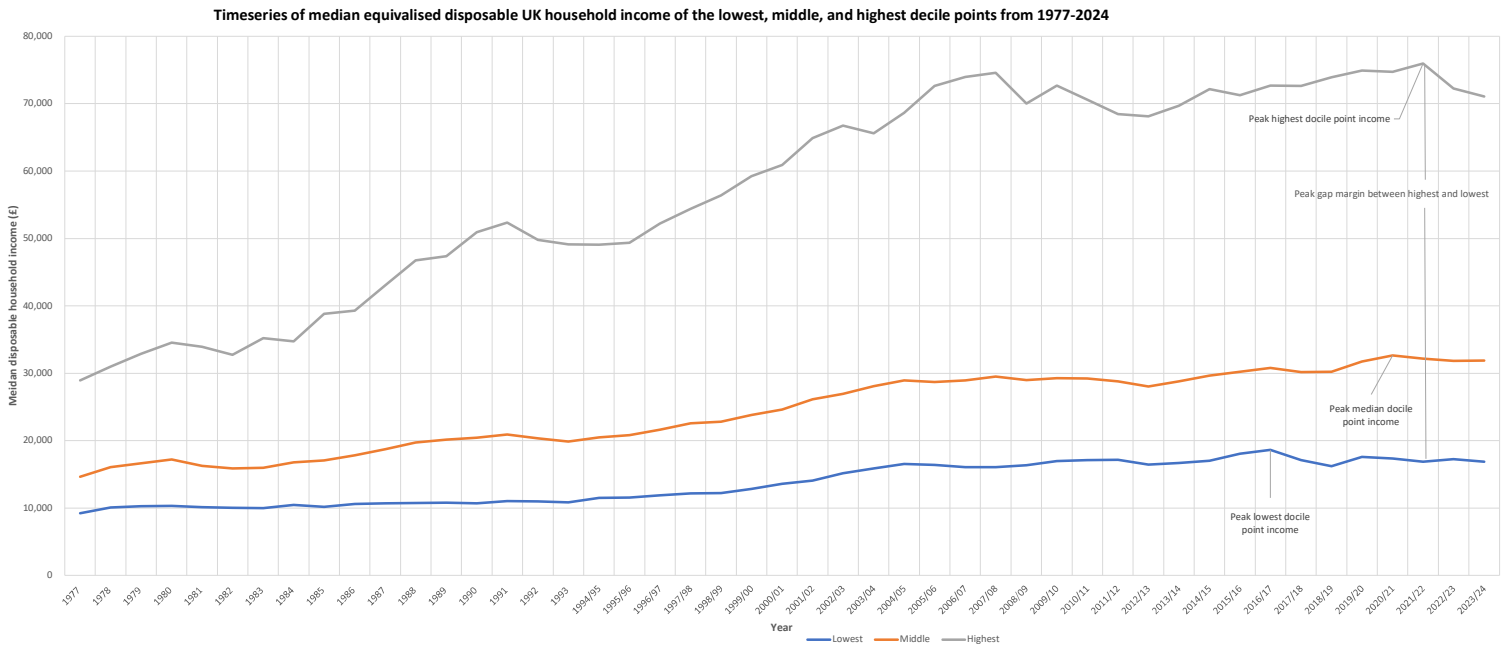
Insights

The gap between top and bottom quartiles has widened over time, indicating increasing income inequality.



Periods of faster gap growth suggest inequality is driven by stronger gains at the top end.

The persistence of a large gap highlights structural differences in income distribution.

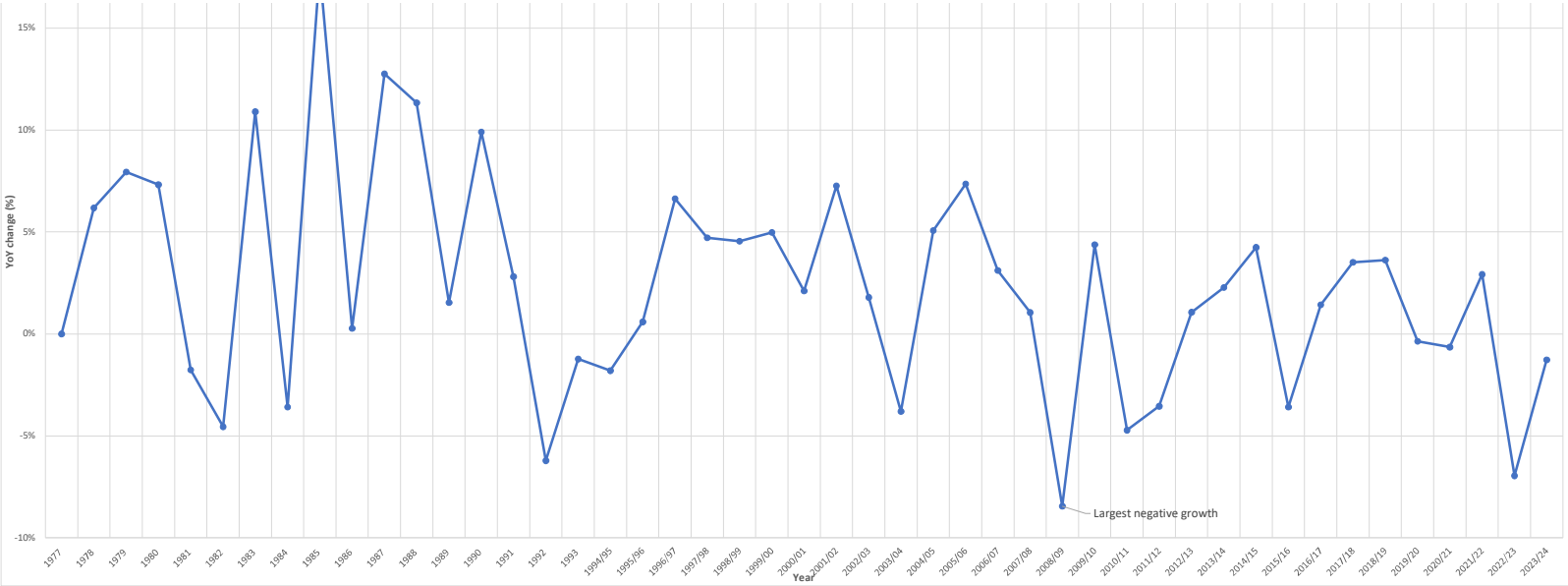


Insights

Income at the top decile is substantially higher than both median and lower decile levels throughout the period.

The gap between the top and lower deciles appears to widen over time, reinforcing inequality trends.

Median income growth is more moderate compared to the top decile, suggesting uneven distribution of gains.



Insights

The rate of change in income inequality varies significantly over time, indicating periods of both widening and narrowing gaps between households.

Periods of strong positive growth indicate accelerating inequality, where higher-income households are pulling further ahead.

Negative growth periods suggest temporary reductions in inequality, potentially driven by slower growth at the top or